

AI AGENTS FOR BUSINESS

What does an AI agent cost per month?

\$74.38

That is our reference configuration: 8 steps per task, 1500 tasks, gpt-5.4-mini, prefix caching. A calculation model on declared assumptions, not our invoices.

THE PROBLEM

“It depends” is not an answer

A price list gives a unit price, not your bill. Three quantities are missing from it: tokens per request, requests per task, and what share of the input is served from cache.

THE SPREAD

Same work, 25× apart

Identical token volume, the same month, two models. Until the assumptions are pinned down, arguing about whether a model is expensive leads nowhere.

<u>gpt-5.4-nano</u>	\$50.34
<u>gpt-5.6-sol</u>	\$1254.00

ANATOMY OF THE BILL

You pay for re-sending, not for intelligence

The model remembers nothing between calls — every step retells it in full. 98.5% of the exchange is input, and cached input is about 90% cheaper.

Stable prefix	15,600
Input per step	19,100
Output per step	300
Cacheable input	82%

CALCULATOR

The bill, broken into parts

The same reference configuration — 8 steps, 1500 tasks, 90% of the prefix from cache — split into five components. The calculator in the article recomputes it on your numbers.

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Component	USD per month	Share of bill
Tool schemas	\$24.62	33%
System prompt	\$2.05	3%
Conversation history	\$18	24%
Retrieved context (RAG)	\$13.5	18%
Model output	\$16.2	22%



MICODE

We will price it on your data

A cost model on your tools, your tasks and your data policy — with an honest read on which levers you can actually pull and which ones run into the architecture.

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